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TOPIC:

COMMUNICATIVE SKILLS

“**Communication skills** are the ability for an individual to accurately convey a message to another person or group of people.”

There are two primary forms of communication:

Verbal communication.

Nonverbal communication.

- **Verbal communication:**

People express their thoughts, ideas, and feelings through spoken or written language.

- **Nonverbal communication:**

People use other methods, such as body language including facial expressions, gestures, and other body movements.

Communicative skills for Teachers:

One of the most important skills of a good teacher is **good communication skills**. Communicating effectively with students creates a positive learning environment and fosters student success. **Good communication skills** also enable teachers to build strong relationships with students, parents, and colleagues.

7 Reasons Why Good Communication Skills Are Important for Teachers?

- **Good Communication Skills Keeps Students in Control:** In today's fast-paced society, teachers must exhibit leadership skills and positive behavior to ensure that students stay focused and have a positive relationship with the teacher and school.
- **Improves Students Learnings:** Students need to be able to learn in a classroom setting if they are going to complete their education and then enter the workforce. On the flip side, students need to be able to understand and interact positively with teachers if they want an education that will help them reach their educational, career, and life goals.
- **Decreases Teacher Turnover:** Teachers who exhibit poor **communication skills** may not last long in a classroom job due to student or parent complaints or teacher resignations due to stress, or other issues related to the job.
- **Improves Parent-Teacher Interaction:** By not communicating with parents or the school, teachers can put themselves in a position to be continually picked on or reprimanded for things that other parents or teachers find offensive. Communication is a two-way process, and mutual respect is the key to any good relationship.
- Suppose a teacher has a [good professional relationship with the parents of their students](#). In that case, it generally means that they are more likely to have continued employment and retain their students' trust and respect.
- **Helps Teachers Spot Problems:** By identifying potential problems with a student early, the teacher can adjust their plans accordingly to help the student reach their various educational goals.
- **Helps In Dealing with Special Needs Children:** Basic communication skills will help teachers respond appropriately when their special needs

child(ren) asks for extra attention. Skills such as patience and emotion rely on the ability to listen to what the child is trying to express or needs help with can make all the difference in a teacher's ability to support these students' needs.

- **Influencing Parents' and Students' Perceptions of Teachers:** Students and parents have much information about teachers based on their initial interactions, classroom interactions, and ongoing conversations with other students or parents who have had positive experiences with that teacher. Teachers who can remain positive and approachable and keep the lines of good communication skills open with students and parents tend to have fewer problems with their instructional program and professional reputation.

Here are a few other ways how teachers can improve communication skills

- Have a systematic plan with clear goals, objectives, and expectations for each class period.
- Have enough engagement with students by involving them in academic activities and experiences outside the classroom.
- Show enthusiasm for the activities that teachers are facilitating in their classrooms.
- Communicate the importance of their role as a teacher and role models to their students.
- Demonstrate positive behavior, language, and instructional techniques.
- Help students find success in school and remind them that they are all learners as well.

❖ Communication Process:

“Communication is the process of passing information and understanding from one person to another” –

Keith Davis

The communication process involves understanding, sharing, and meaning, and it consists of eight essential elements: source, message, channel, receiver, feedback, environment, context, and interference.

COMMUNICATION CYCLE:

Communication process/Cycle involves the following elements.

1. Sender:

- Sender is the source of Communication. All Communication requires a source.
- Any communication starts from the source or sender. Sender has some thoughts, ideas, needs or information that he wishes to transmit to another person.

2. Message:

- This is the subject - matter of communication.
- This may be opinions, attitudes, feelings, views, suggestions, order etc.

3.Encoding:

The sender uses certain symbols such as words, actions; pictures etc. (or) the ideas are translated into a code or a set of symbols especially in the form of language.

Conversion of the subject - matter into these symbols is the process of encoding.

4. Channel:

- These symbols are transmitted through certain channels.
- For example, radio, telephone, letter, face to face talk, depending upon the situation of the two parties namely „sender“ and „receiver“ (or) It is the link that connects the sender and the receiver.

5. Receiver:

A person who receives and interprets the message (student)

6. Decoding:

It means translating the message into words for the purpose of understanding.

7. Feedback:

It refers to the reaction, reply or the response sent by the receiver to the sender. Or

It is the response the receiver gives to the sender as a result of sender's

message
 Sender (Teacher) Message Encoding Channel Feedback Decoding
 Receiver (Student).

Directions of Communication:

Communication flows both formally and informally.

Formal communication follows the official hierarchy, and it flows through formal channels. This type of communication can flow in two directions- **vertical, lateral or diagonal.**

Lateral/Horizontal Communication:

Lateral or Horizontal communication occurs between people of the same status—sales staff, departmental heads, directors, managers etc. Lateral communication is often necessary to save time and facilitate coordination.

Vertical Direction:

Vertical direction can be further divided into downward and upward direction.

Downward Communication:

- Communication that goes from one level in a group or organization to a lower level is Downward Communication.
- Managers communicating with subordinates.
- This pattern is used by group leaders and managers to assign goals,
- provide job instructions, point out problems that need attention and
- offer feedback about performance. Downward communication does not have to be oral or interpersonal.

Upward Communication:

Upward Communication flows from a lower level in a group or organization to a higher level. It is used:

- To provide feedback to higher ups.
- To inform them of progress toward goals.
- To relay current problems.
- Superior - sub-ordinate discussions.

Informal communication, usually known as **Diagonal or crosswise**, allows in all directions. In the informal system, information flows along the well-known **grapevine & rumors**.

Diagonal/Cross-wise Communication:

Diagonal or cross-wise communication is free to move in any direction. This type of communication involves more than one department and there is often no line of authority.

Rumors

- Rumors are always connected matters that we are greatly interested in, and never about matters that we are not interested in.
- Rumors are always over matters surrounded by uncertainty, doubt or ambiguity and involve conjecturing over what facts really are.

Grapevine

- It is not controlled by management.
- It is perceived by most employees as being more reliable & believable than formal communication issued by top management.
- It is hugely used to serve the self-interest of those people within it.

Communication, whether formal or informal, is all about understanding. Our aim should be to communicate a message successfully so that it is received without any misunderstanding.

❖ **Barriers To Communication:**

Effective communication is essential for nurturing a successful school environment. Good communication between teachers, students, and parents can create a positive learning space and improve academic outcomes. However, several barriers to effective communication exist in schools, hindering the flow of information and leading to misunderstandings. In this blog, we explore five common barriers to communication in schools.

Language Barriers:

Language barriers are one of the most significant obstacles to effective communication. When students and parents speak different languages, it can be challenging to understand each other. To overcome this barrier, schools can use translation and interpretation services, either in-person or through a school communication app. Teachers can also use visual aids such as pictures, diagrams, and videos to make communication easier. However, effective communication isn't just about words. Paying attention to non-verbal cues such as body language is also crucial. By seeking different ways to communicate positively, both students and teachers can better understand each other and work together to achieve academic success.

Technological Barriers:

In today's digital age, technology plays a significant role in communication. However, technological barriers such as outdated equipment, poor internet connectivity, and lack of technical skills can hinder effective communication in schools. Teachers and administrators need to be proficient in using technology to communicate with students, parents, and colleagues. By identifying these barriers, schools can take steps to overcome them, such as offering training to teachers, students, and parents, and investing in reliable technology. With improved communication and the use of school communication apps, the educational process can become more collaborative, leading to better academic outcomes for students.

Physical Barriers

Physical barriers such as noisy classrooms, poor lighting, and crowded spaces can also hinder effective communication in schools. Students and teachers may find it challenging to hear, understand each other or retain full attention in noisy classrooms or poorly lit spaces. Schools need to provide comfortable and conducive learning environments that facilitate effective communication.

Cultural Barriers

Cultural differences can also create communication barriers in schools. Different cultures have different communication styles, customs, and expectations. These differences can lead to misunderstandings, misinterpretations, and conflicts. Schools need to educate their staff on cultural sensitivity and diversity to avoid cultural barriers to communication. Teachers should also be aware of a child's cultural upbringing and heritage in order to develop stronger communication pathways with parents, whanau or community members.

Emotional Barriers

Emotional barriers can hinder effective communication in schools. Students experiencing anxiety may struggle to communicate with their teachers, and stressed teachers may find it difficult to communicate with students. To overcome these barriers, schools can promote active listening and a positive environment that encourages open communication. [Counselling services and classroom activities that support mental health and well-being can create a safe and welcoming environment for all.](#) By addressing emotional barriers, students and teachers can communicate effectively, leading to improved academic outcomes and a better school experience for all.

In conclusion, effective communication is critical in schools to foster positive relationships, improve academic outcomes, and create an inclusive learning environment. However, several barriers to communication can exist, hindering the flow of information and leading to misunderstandings. Schools can promote effective communication by using [school communication apps](#) such as School Loop to foster the development of good communication strategies and overcome some of these barriers.

